

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 8 4

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ J 8 2

♠ A K 6

♥ A 10 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ 10 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 2

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ K Q 3

♣ 6

♠ 8 7 3

♥ 6 2

♦ 7 5 4

♣ A K Q 5 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♥

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

You need two more winners. Barring a 4-0 ♣ split your two extra winners will be the ♣5 and ♣3.

So after winning the ♥A, you play a ♣ to dummy's ♣Q and breathe a sigh of relief when both defenders follow suit.

UhOh. Surely you didn't play your ♣4 to dummy's ♣Q???

If you did then just look at the situation now. If the ♣J doesn't fall on the next trick the suit will be blocked. Now go back in time and play the ♣10 to dummy's ♣Q.

That's better. Now under the ♣ A K you can unblock the ♣ 9 7, which will leave you with the ♣4 to slip under dummy's ♣5.

Watch those spot cards. You may have to unblock them to stay in the hand you want to be in.

Partner's jump to 3NT is a lebensohl method.

He is describing a hand with which he would have bid 3NT if there had been no overcall. But he is warning you that he **DOES NOT HAVE** a ♥ stopper!

Since you **DO** have a ♥ stopper you decide to pass and play 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥K.

You hold up your ♥A until the third round.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 7

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 5 3

♥ K J 7

♦ 6 2

♣ 8 4

♠ 6

♥ Q 9 8 5 3 2

♦ Q 10

♣ A J 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 4 2

♥ A 6

♦ A J 8 4 3

♣ Q 7 2

♠ 10 8 7

♥ 10 4

♦ K 9 7 5

♣ K 10 9 5

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

You decide to use a transfer so the lead will be into whatever holding partner has in the minor suits. You bid 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

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You are nowhere near strong enough to be thinking of slam so you bid 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by West.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♣10. North wins the ♣A. They continue ♣s and you ruff the third one in dummy.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 3

Those losers are based on dummy's hand, not yours. You can figure them either way but it is usually easier to determine losers based on the long-trump hand. It's important to remember it in this Deal because the zero losers in ♥s assumes you will ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Pull one round of trumps with dummy's ♠K. Both defenders follow suit. Play the ♥A, then ♥6 to dummy's ♥K. On this trick South follows with the ♥10.

The Plan is still the same, you will ruff the ♥ in your hand, but you better be sure to ruff with your ♠A. Aha! Your precaution pays off when South shows out of ♥s, but of course he cannot over-ruff your ♠A.

A very good Bridge maxim is this: When you are ruffing, ruff with as high a trump as you can afford.

Here, with only 2 trumps left out, you can afford the ♠A.